



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Jamaica. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing a bit about yourself — you're at an exciting point in life with a lot of possibilities ahead!

Since you've just finished **primary school in Denmark**, the most immediate decision you're likely facing is whether to pursue **gymnasium, vocational education (EUD/Erhvervsuddannelse)**, or another path like **10th grade (10. klasse)** if you're unsure.

Here's a breakdown of your main options, with some advice depending on your interests and goals:

## 1. Gymnasium (STX, HHX, HTX, HF) – Academic Path

This is for you if you're thinking of going to university later or want to keep your options open. There are different types:

- **STX**: General upper secondary education – includes a mix of humanities, sciences, and languages. Great if you're interested in a broad academic foundation.
- **HHX**: Focuses on business, economics, and languages – ideal if you like marketing, international trade, or want to run your own business one day.
- **HTX**: More technical/science-focused – good if you're into technology, science, or engineering.
- **HF**: Shorter (2 years), a bit more practical – good if you want a more hands-on version of academic education and don't want to commit to 3 years.

✓ *Recommended if you like school subjects, want to go to university, or don't yet know what to specialize in.*

## 2. Vocational Education and Training (Erhvervsuddannelse / EUD) – Hands-On Careers

This path trains you for a specific job, often through a combination of school and apprenticeships.

Some examples of vocational tracks:

- Electrician, mechanic, carpenter, or chef
- Hairdresser, healthcare assistant, child care worker
- IT support, multimedia design

✓ *Recommended if you prefer practical work and want to get into the job market sooner (usually in 3–4 years with paid internships).*

### 3. 10th Grade (10. klasse) – Extra Year to Decide

If you're not sure what to choose yet, you can take a 10th-grade year either at a regular school, an **efterskole** (boarding school), or a special 10th-grade center.

 *Recommended if you want time to think, improve grades, or try new subjects in a different environment.*

#### How to Choose? Ask Yourself:

- Do I like academic subjects and homework? → **Gymnasium**
- Do I like working with my hands or learning by doing? → **Vocational education**
- Do I want to run my own business or work in trade/finance? → **HHX**
- Do I enjoy science and technology? → **HTX**
- Do I want more time to explore and mature? → **10th grade**

#### Bonus Tip: Consider Your Passions and Roots

Since your parents are from Jamaica, you have a unique cultural background. That can be an asset in international studies, language learning, business, or even careers involving diversity, tourism, or global trade.

And being fluent in Danish gives you full access to all public education in Denmark — free and high-quality.

#### Final Suggestion

If you're unsure:

- Consider **taking 10th grade** at an **efterskole**, especially one with a focus (e.g., music, sports, entrepreneurship, or global culture).
- Then, after a year of discovering more about yourself, you can move on to gymnasium or vocational school with more confidence.

If you'd like, I can help you explore local schools, compare STX/HHX/HTX options, or even give you quizzes to figure out your strengths. Just let me know!